

Finland

Ratio: 11:18 **Adopted:** May 29, 1918 **Usage:** National and Civil

The overall design is based on the Scandinavian cross



Blue represents Finland's blue skies and its thousands of lakes

White recalls the snows of winter

Europe



Finland was part of Sweden from the 12th century. From 1809 until independence in 1917, it was part of the Russian Empire.

Like Sweden's, Finland's national flag is based on the Scandinavian cross.

It was adopted after independence from Russia, when many patriotic Finns wanted a special flag for their country, but its design dates back to the 19th century. The blue coloring is said to represent the country's thousands of lakes and the sky, with white for the snow that covers

the land in winter. This color combination has also been used over the centuries in various Finnish provincial, military, and town flags.

THE ÅLAND ISLANDS

The Åland Islands are an autonomous group of Finnish islands with their own flag since 1954. The design incorporates a Scandinavian cross.

THE FLAG OF THE ÅLAND ISLANDS



Red and yellow are taken from the arms of Finland. Blue and yellow represent Sweden; the islands have a large Swedish population